Dr. Lara J. Martin

Assistant Professor, CSEE • University of Maryland, Baltimore County (UMBC)

Information Technology and Engineering (ITE) Building, Room 342-A

laramar@umbc.edu | laramartin.net

Google Scholar | Github | LinkedIn

Research Interests

Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Natural Language Processing/Generation, Neurosymbolic Methods for NLP, Computational Creativity, Automated Story Generation & Understanding, Tabletop Roleplaying Agents, Augmentative & Alternative Communication (AAC), Assistive Technologies (AT), Speech Processing, Affective Computing

Education

Georgia Institute of Technology — *Aug. 2015 - May 2021*

Ph.D. in Human-Centered Computing — *Atlanta, GA*

+ Advisor: Dr. Mark O. Riedl
+ Thesis: Neurosymbolic Automated Story Generation
+ Teaching Certification: Tech to Teaching (Summer 2018)

Carnegie Mellon University — *Aug. 2013 – May 2015*

M.S. in Language Technologies — *Pittsburgh, PA*

+ Advisor: Dr. Alan W Black

Rutgers University — New Brunswick — *Sep. 2009 – May 2013*

B.S. in Computer Science & Linguistics (double major) — *Piscataway, NJ*

+ Advisor: Dr. Matthew Stone

Research Experience

Assistant Professor — *Aug 2023 – Present*

University of Maryland, Baltimore County — *Baltimore, MD*

Computer Science and Electrical Engineering (CSEE) Department

Affiliate of the Information Systems Department

Computing Innovation Fellow (CIFellow) Postdoctoral Researcher — *Jan 2021 – Aug 2023*

University of Pennsylvania — *Philadelphia, PA*

Computer and Information Science Department

Graduate Research Assistant — *Aug 2015 – Dec 2020*

Georgia Institute of Technology — *Atlanta, GA*

School of Interactive Computing

Applied Scientist Intern — *May 2017 – Aug 2017*

Amazon.com Inc. — *Seattle, WA*

Alexa Smart Home Machine Learning

Graduate Research Assistant — *Sept 2013 – Aug 2015*

Carnegie Mellon University — *Pittsburgh, PA*

Language Technologies Institute

Intern, Virtual Patient Project — *May 2011 – Aug 2011*

University of Southern California — *Playa Vista, CA*

Institute for Creative Technologies

Teaching

University of Maryland, Baltimore County

CMSC 473/673 Natural Language Processing

Spring 2026 – Instructor of Record
Spring 2025 – Instructor of Record
Spring 2024 – Instructor of Record

CMSC 491/691 Interactive Fiction and Text Generation

Fall 2025 – Instructor of Record
Fall 2024 – Instructor of Record

CMSC 671 Principles of Artificial Intelligence

Fall 2023 – Instructor of Record

University of Pennsylvania

CIS 700 Interactive Fiction and Text Generation

Spring 2022 – Co-Instructor, Co-taught with Dr. Chris Callison-Burch

Georgia Institute of Technology

Clarks Scholars Summer Python Bootcamp

Summer 2019 – Course Materials, Co-created syllabus/lesson plan with Dr. Cassandra Kent

CS 3790 Introduction to Cognitive Science

Summer 2018 – Instructor of Record

Projects

Human-AI Communication and Computational Creativity. Collaboration between people and AI, primarily through storytelling.

Story understanding	[4, 7, 20]	*2021 – Present*
D&D-Playing and Strategic Agents	[3, 6, 8, 15, 18, 19, 22]	*2018 – Present*
Story generation	[1, 9–12, 16, 17, 21, 23, 24, 33]	*2015 – Present*
Schemas	[5, 11, 12]	*2023*
Conversational agents	[28], See also: Amazon & USC ICT internships	*2011, 2017, 2022*
Language learning	[26]	*2014*

Human-Human Communication. Analysis of human-human communication or computer-mediated communication.

Augmentative and Alternative Communication (AAC)	[2, 32]	*2022 – Present*
Emotion recognition & affective computing	[2, 14, 29–31]	*2013 – Present*
Online communities	[7, 25]	*2014, 2023*
Translation	[13]	*2015*

Publications

PhD Dissertation

[1] **L. J. Martin**. "Neurosymbolic Automated Story Generation". Doctoral dissertation. Georgia Institute of Technology, 2021. URL: https://smartech.gatech.edu/handle/1853/64643.

Conference Proceedings

*equal contribution, †presented

[2] S. Choudhury†, A. Kumar, and **L. J. Martin**. "Evaluating Human-LLM Representation Alignment: A Case Study on Affective Sentence Generation for Augmentative and Alternative Communication". In: *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: IJCNLP-AACL 2025*. Mumbai, India, Dec. 2025, pp. 1618–1637. arXiv: 2503.11881. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2025.findings-ijcnlp.100/. [12% acceptance rate].

[3] A. Zhu†, **L. J. Martin**†, A. Head, and C. Callison-Burch. "CALYPSO: LLMs as Dungeon Master's Assistants". In: *AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE)*. Vol. 19. 1. Salt Lake City, UT: AAAI, Oct. 2023, pp. 380–390. DOI: 10.1609/aiide.v19i1.27534. arXiv: 2308.07540. URL: https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AIIDE/article/view/27534. [∼59% acceptance rate].

[4] Y. R. Dong, **L. J. Martin**, and C. Callison-Burch. "CoRRPUS: Code-based Structured Prompting for Neurosymbolic Story Understanding". In: *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2023*. Toronto, Canada: ACL, July 2023, pp. 13152–13168. arXiv: 2212.10754. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2023.findings-acl.832/. [18.4% acceptance rate].

[5] T. Zhang*†, I. Tham*, Z. Hou*, J. Ren, L. Zhou, H. Xu, L. Zhang, **L. J. Martin**, R. Dror, S. Li, H. Ji, M. Palmer, S. Brown, R. Suchocki, and C. Callison-Burch. "Human-in-the-Loop Schema Induction". In: *Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*. Vol. 3: System Demonstrations. Toronto, Canada: ACL, July 2023, pp. 1–10. arXiv: 2302.13048. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2023.acl-demo.1/. [37% acceptance rate].

[6] A. Zhu†, K. Aggarwal, A. Feng, **L. J. Martin**, and C. Callison-Burch. "FIREBALL: A Dataset of Dungeons and Dragons Actual-Play with Structured Game State Information". In: *Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*. Vol. 1: Long Papers. Toronto, Canada: ACL, July 2023, pp. 4171–4193. arXiv: 2305.01528. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2023.acl-long.229/. [23.5% acceptance rate].

[7] S. Giorgi, K. Zhao, A. H. Feng, and **L. J. Martin**†. "Author as Character and Narrator: Deconstructing Personal Narratives from the *r/AmITheAsshole* Reddit Community". In: *International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM)*. Vol. 17. 1. Limassol, Cyprus: AAAI, June 2023, pp. 233–244. arXiv: 2301.08104. URL: https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/ICWSM/article/view/22141. [∼20% acceptance rate].

[8] C. Callison-Burch*, G. S. Tomar*†, **L. J. Martin**, D. Ippolito, S. Bailis, and D. Reitter. "Dungeons and Dragons as a Dialogue Challenge for Artificial Intelligence". In: *Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates: ACL, Dec. 2022, pp. 9379–9393. arXiv: 2210.07109. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2022.emnlp-main.637. [22.1% acceptance rate].

[9] P. Ammanabrolu†, E. Tien, W. Cheung, Z. Luo, W. Ma, **L. J. Martin**†, and M. O. Riedl. "Story Realization: Expanding Plot Events into Sentences". In: *AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)*. Vol. 34. 5. New York, NY: AAAI, Apr. 2020, pp. 7375–7382. DOI: 10.1609/aaai.v34i05.6232. arXiv: 1909.03480. URL: https://ojs.aaai.org//index.php/AAAI/article/view/6232. [20.6% acceptance rate].

[10] P. Tambwekar*, M. Dhuliawala*†, **L. J. Martin**†, A. Mehta, B. Harrison, and M. O. Riedl. "Controllable Neural Story Plot Generation via Reward Shaping". In: *International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI)*. Macao, China, July 2019, pp. 5982–5988. DOI: 10.24963/ijcai.2019/829. arXiv: 1809.10736. URL: https://www.ijcai.org/proceedings/2019/829. [17.9% acceptance rate].

[11] **L. J. Martin**†, P. Ammanabrolu, X. Wang, W. Hancock, S. Singh, B. Harrison, and M. O. Riedl. "Event Representations for Automated Story Generation with Deep Neural Nets". In: *AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)*. Vol. 32. 1. New Orleans, LA: AAAI, Feb. 2018, pp. 868–875. ISBN: 978-1-57735-800-8. DOI: 10.1609/aaai.v32i1.11430. arXiv: 1706.01331. URL: https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/AAAI/article/view/11430. [24.6% acceptance rate].

[12] **L. J. Martin**†, B. Harrison, and M. O. Riedl. "Improvisational Computational Storytelling in Open Worlds". In: *International Conference on Interactive Digital Storytelling (ICIDS)*. Ed. by F. Nack and A. Gordon. Vol. 10045. Lecture Notes in Computer Science (LNCS). Los Angeles, CA: Springer, Oct. 2016, pp. 73–84. ISBN: 978-3-319-48278-1. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-319-48279-8_7. URL: https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-319-48279-8_7. [36% acceptance rate].

[13] **L. J. Martin**†, A. Wilkinson†, S. S. Miryala, V. Robison, and A. W. Black. "Utterance Classification in Speech-to-Speech Translation for Zero-Resource Languages in the Hospital Administration Domain". In: *2015 IEEE Workshop on Automatic Speech Recognition and Understanding (ASRU)*. Scottsdale, AZ: IEEE, Dec. 2015, pp. 303–309. DOI: 10.1109/ASRU.2015.7404809. URL: https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/7404809. [47.8% acceptance rate].

[14] **L. J. Martin**†, M. Stone, F. Metze, and J. Mostow. "A Methodology for Using Crowdsourced Data to Measure Uncertainty in Natural Speech". In: *2014 IEEE Spoken Language Technology Workshop (SLT)*. South Lake Tahoe, NV: IEEE, Dec. 2014, pp. 95–99. DOI: 10.1109/SLT.2014.7078556. URL: https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/7078556. [48.6% acceptance rate].

Peer-Reviewed Workshop Papers

*equal contribution, †presented

[15] P. Delafuente†, A. Honraopatil†, and **L. J. Martin**. "Does Reasoning Help LLM Agents Play Dungeons and Dragons? A Prompt Engineering Experiment". In: *EMNLP 2025 Fifth Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Suzhou, China, Nov. 2025. arXiv: 2510.18112. URL: https://wordplay-workshop.github.io/pdfs/29.pdf.

[16] R. Huang†, **L. J. Martin**, and C. Callison-Burch. "WHAT-IF: Exploring Branching Narratives by Meta-Prompting Large Language Models". In: *EMNLP 2025 Fifth Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Suzhou, China, Nov. 2025. arXiv: 2412.10582. URL: https://wordplay-workshop.github.io/pdfs/4.pdf.

[17] R. Chambers†, N. Tack, E. Pearson, **L. J. Martin**, and F. Ferraro. "BERALL: Generating Retrieval-augmented State-based Interactive Fiction Games". In: *ACL 2024 Fourth Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Bangkok, Thailand, Aug. 2024. URL: https://wordplay-workshop.github.io/wordplay2024/pdfs/21.pdf.

[18] C. Callison-Burch*†, G. S. Tomar*, **L. J. Martin**, D. Ippolito, S. Bailis, and D. Reitter. "Dungeons and Dragons as a Dialogue Challenge for Artificial Intelligence". In: *NAACL 2022 Third Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Virtual/Seattle, WA, July 2022. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=EKwH-BMlkzq.

[19] S. Papazov†, W. Gill, M. Garcia Ferreiro, A. Zhu, **L. J. Martin**, and C. Callison-Burch. "Using Language Models to Convert Between Natural Language and Game Commands". In: *NAACL 2022 Third Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop*. Virtual/Seattle, WA, July 2022. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=jQSStHwtmDN.

[20] B. Li†, **L. J. Martin**, and C. Callison-Burch. "CIS^2: A Simplified Commonsense Inference Evaluation for Story Prose". In: *ACL 2022 Workshop on Commonsense Representation and Reasoning (CSRR)*. Virtual/Dublin, Ireland, Mar. 2022. arXiv: 2202.07880. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=Se-xHMYg_bc.

[21] P. Ammanabrolu†, E. Tien, W. Cheung, Z. Luo, W. Ma, **L. J. Martin**, and M. O. Riedl. "Guided Neural Language Generation for Automated Storytelling". In: *ACL 2019 Second Workshop on Storytelling (StoryNLP)*. Florence, Italy: ACL, Aug. 2019, pp. 46–55. DOI: 10.18653/v1/W19-3405. URL: https://aclanthology.org/W19-3405/.

[22] **L. J. Martin**†, S. Sood, and M. Riedl. "Dungeons and DQNs: Toward Reinforcement Learning Agents that Play Tabletop Roleplaying Games". In: *Joint AIIDE Workshop on Intelligent Narrative Technologies and Workshop on Intelligent Cinematography and Editing (INT-WICED)*. Ed. by H.-Y. Wu, M. Si, and A. Jhala. Edmonton, AB, Canada: http://ceur-ws.org, Nov. 2018. URL: http://ceur-ws.org/Vol-2321/paper4.pdf.

[23] **L. J. Martin**†, P. Ammanabrolu, X. Wang, S. Singh, B. Harrison, M. Dhuliawala, P. Tambwekar, A. Mehta, R. Arora, N. Dass, C. Purdy, and M. O. Riedl. "Improvisational Storytelling Agents". In: *NeurIPS 2017 Workshop on Machine Learning for Creativity and Design*. Long Beach, CA, Dec. 2017. URL: https://nips2017creativity.github.io/doc/Improvisational_Agents.pdf.

[24] **L. J. Martin**†, P. Ammanabrolu, W. Hancock, S. Singh, B. Harrison, and M. O. Riedl. "Event Representations for Automated Story Generation with Deep Neural Nets". In: *KDD 2017 Workshop on Machine Learning for Creativity*. Halifax, NS, Canada, Aug. 2017. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/1706.01331v2. [38% acceptance rate].

[25] S. Moon†, S. Potdar, and **L. J. Martin**. "Identifying Student Leaders from MOOC Discussion Forums through Language Influence". In: *EMNLP 2014 Workshop on Analysis of Large Scale Social Interaction in MOOCs*. Doha, Qatar, Oct. 2014, pp. 15–20. DOI: 10.3115/v1/W14-4103. URL: https://www.aclweb.org/anthology/W14-4103/.

[26] N. Wolfe†, V. V. Vemuri, **L. J. Martin**†, F. Metze, and A. W. Black. "Applause: A Learning Tool for Low-Resource Languages". In: *CHI 2014 Designing Speech and Language Interactions Workshop (DSLI)*. Toronto, ON, Canada, Apr. 2014. URL: http://www.cs.toronto.edu/dsli2014/submissions/applause-chi-paper-photo-ready.pdf.

Other Publications

[27] A. Honraopatil†, S. Vallurupalli, and **L. J. Martin**. "Shaping Perception of Emotional Storytelling with Synthesized Speech". In: *Mid-Atlantic Student Colloquium on AI, Language, and Learning (MASC-ALL)*. State College, PA, USA, Apr. 2025.

[28] A. Panagopoulou, M. Arora, L. Zhang, D. Cugini, W. You, Y. Yang, L. Zhou, Y. Wang, Z. Hou, A. Hwang, **L. J. Martin**, S. Shi, C. Callison-Burch, and M. Yatskar. "QuakerBot: A Household Dialog System Powered by Large Language Models". In: *1st Alexa Prize TaskBot (Alexa Prize 2021)*. May 2022. URL: https://www.amazon.science/alexa-prize/proceedings/quakerbot-a-household-dialog-system-powered-by-large-language-models.

[29] S. Yu, L. Jiang, Z. Xu, Z. Lan, S. Xu, X. Chang, X. Li, Z. Mao, C. Gan, Y. Miao, X. Du, Y. Cai, **L. J. Martin**, N. Wolfe, A. Kumar, H. Li, M. Lin, Z. Ma, Y. Yang, D. Meng, S. Shan, P. D. Sahin, S. Burger, F. Metze, R. Singh, B. Raj, T. Mitamura, R. Stern, and A. Hauptmann. "CMU informedia@TrecVID 2015 MED/SIN/LNK/SED". In: *TREC Video Retrieval Evaluation 2015*. Gaithersburg, MD, Nov. 2015. URL: https://research.monash.edu/en/publications/cmu-informediatrecvid-2015-medsinlnksed.

[30] S. Yu, L. Jiang, Z. Mao, X. Chang, X. Du, C. Gan, Z. Lan, Z. Xu, X. Li, Y. Cai, A. Kumar, Y. Miao, **L. J. Martin**, N. Wolfe, S. Xu, H. Li, M. Lin, Z. Ma, Y. Yang, D. Meng, S. Shan, P. Duygulu Sahin, S. Burger, F. Metze, R. Singh, B. Raj, T. Mitamura, R. Stern, and A. Hauptmann. "Informedia@TRECVID 2014 MED and MER". In: *TRECVID Video Retrieval Evaluation Workshop, NIST*. Gaithersburg, MD, Nov. 2014. URL: https://apps.dtic.mil/sti/citations/AD1024376.

[31] S. Cosentino†, S. Burger, **L. J. Martin**, F. Metze, T. Kishi, K. Hashimoto, S. Sessa, M. Zecca, and A. Takanishi. "A multi-sensory non-invasive system for laughter analysis". In: *36th Annual International Conference of the IEEE Engineering in Medicine and Biology Society (EMBC)*. Chicago, IL, Aug. 2014. URL: https://laramartin.net/pub/EMBC14-Laughter.pdf.

Preprints

[32] **L. J. Martin** and M. Nagalakshmi. *Aging Up AAC: An Introspection on Augmentative and Alternative Communication Applications for Autistic Adults*. Apr. 2024. arXiv: 2404.17730. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2404.17730.

[33] A. Alabdulkarim, W. Li, **L. J. Martin**, and M. O. Riedl. *Goal-Directed Story Generation: Augmenting Generative Language Models with Reinforcement Learning*. Dec. 2021. arXiv: 2112.08593. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2112.08593.

Grants and Awards

Grants

Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AAAI) — *2025 – 2026*
"DC-Baltimore AAAI AIxAccessibility Event" — **$1,000**
Lara J. Martin, Foad Hamidi, Stephanie Valencia, Abraham Glasser — *UMBC*

UMBC COEIT Interdisciplinary Proposals — *2024 – 2025*
"Investigating the Social and Affective Aspects of Large-Language Model-based Augmentative and Alternative Communication Systems" — **$20,000**
Foad Hamidi (Co-PI), Lara J. Martin (Co-PI) — *UMBC*

UMBC Summer Research Faculty Fellowship (SuRFF) — *2024*
"Reinforcement Learning for Playing Dungeons & Dragons" — **$8,000**
Lara J. Martin — *UMBC*

National Science Foundation & Computing Research Association — *2021 – 2023*
(NSF 2030859) Computing Innovation Postdoctoral Fellowship — **$200,000**
Lara J. Martin (Postdoc), Chris Callison-Burch (Faculty Mentor) — *University of Pennsylvania*

Awards

James D. Foley GVU Center Endowment — *2019*
Foley Scholar Award — **$5,000**
Lara J. Martin — *Georgia Institute of Technology*

Service

Institutional

Redefine Excellence in Research and Creative Achievement Subgroup for UMBC's Strategic Planning — *January 2026 – Present*
Committee Member — *UMBC*

Barry Goldwater Scholarship & Excellence in Education Foundation — *Fall 2025 – Present*
Committee Member — *UMBC*

Language Technology Seminar Series (LaTeSS) — *Fall 2024 – Present*
Creator & Organizer — *UMBC*

ACM Richard Tapia Celebration of Diversity in Computing — *September 10-12, 2025*
UMBC Representative

College of Engineering and Information Technology (COEIT) Research Day — *Spring 2025*
Working Group Member — *UMBC*

Faculty Senate's Ad Hoc Committee on AI Integration in the Classroom — *Fall 2024 – Spring 2025*
Committee Member — *UMBC*

Teaching about LLMs to Faculty Learning Committees (FLCs) — *Fall 2023 – Spring 2024*
Volunteer — *UMBC*
Teaching in the era of AI FLC (11/17/2023, 4/19/2024)
AI in the Classroom FLC (12/8/2023)

Departmental

Computer Science AI/ML Undergrad Track Director — *Fall 2025 – Present*
UMBC, CSEE

Inclusive Excellence Committee — *Spring 2025 – Present*
Co-Founder, Committee Member — *UMBC, CSEE*

Department Library Liaison — *Fall 2024 – Present*
UMBC, CSEE

Graduate Admissions Committee — *Fall 2023 – Present*
Committee Member — *UMBC, CSEE*

Undergraduate CS Academic Advisor — *Fall 2023 – Fall 2025*
UMBC, CSEE

Professional Activities

Summary

10	**Organizer/Guest Editor**
13	**Area Chair/Senior Area Chair Positions**
4	**Grant Reviewer**
37	**Program Committee Member/Reviewer, including Journal Reviewer**
64	**Total Participation**

Organizer and Guest Editor Positions

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *November 10-14, 2025*
Ethics Chair — *Edmonton, Canada*

5th Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop at EMNLP 2025 — *November 9, 2025*
Co-Organizer — *Suzhou, China*

IEEE Transactions on Games: Special Issue on Large Language Models and Games — *May 2025*
Guest Editor

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *November 18-22, 2024*
Ethics & Conference Experience Chair — *Lexington, KY*

4th Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop at ACL 2024 — *August 16, 2024*
Co-Organizer — *Bangkok, Thailand*

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *October 11-15, 2021*
Doctoral Consortium Chair — *Virtual*

3rd Workshop on Narrative Understanding at NAACL 2021 — *June 11, 2021*
Co-Organizer — *Virtual*

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *October 19-23, 2020*
Publicity Co-Chair — *Virtual*

1st Workshop on Narrative Understanding, Storylines, and Events (NUSE) at ACL 2020 — *July 9, 2020*
Co-Organizer — *Virtual*

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *October 8-12, 2019*
Local Arrangements Chair — *Altanta, GA*

Other Chair Positions

International Conference on Natural Language Generation (INLG) — *October 29-November 2, 2025*
Area Chair — *Hanoi, Vietnam*

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *October 8-12, 2023*
Session Chair — *Salt Lake City, UT*

International Conference on Natural Language Generation (INLG) — *September 11-15, 2023*
Area Chair — *Prague, Czechia*

International Conference on Natural Language Generation (INLG) — *September 20-24, 2021*
Area Chair — *Aberdeen, UK*

International Conference for Interactive Digital Storytelling (ICIDS) — *December 5-8, 2018*
Associate Program Chair – Technologies Track — *Dublin, Ireland*

Grant Reviewer

2025 **National Science Foundation (IIS)**
2025 **Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft**
2025 **National Science Foundation**
2022 **Army Research Office**

Journal Reviewer

2024 **IEEE Transactions on Games**
2023 **IEEE Transactions on Games**
2021 **Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems (Springer)**
2020 **IEEE Transactions on Audio, Speech and Language Processing**
2020 **ACM Computing Surveys (CSUR)**

ACL Rolling Review

March 2026 **Senior Area Chair** *– ACL 2026*
May 2025 **Senior Area Chair** *– EMNLP 2025*
March 2025 **Reviewer** *– ACL 2025*
February 2024 **Area Chair** *– ACL 2024*
December 2023 **Area Chair** *– NAACL 2024*
October 2023 **Area Chair** *– EACL 2024*
August 2023 **Area Chair**
April 2023 **Area Chair**
December 2022 **Area Chair**
October 2022 **Reviewer**
July 2022 **Reviewer**
April 2022 **Reviewer**
January 2022 **Reviewer**

Program Committee Member (Reviewer)

ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing — *April 13-17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain*

AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) — *November 10-14, 2025, Edmonton, Canada*

5th Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop at EMNLP 2025 — *November 9, 2025, Suzhou, China*

Computational Models of Narrative Workshop — *May 28-30, 2025, Geneva, Switzerland*

AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES)	*October 20-22, 2025* *Madrid, Spain*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Doctoral Consortium	*November 18-22, 2024* *Lexington, KY*
International Conference on Natural Language Generation (INLG)	*September 23-27, 2024* *Tokyo, Japan*
Annual Symposium on Computer-Human Interaction in Play (CHI PLAY)	*October 14-17, 2024* *Tampere, Finland*
Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) Student Research Workshop	*August 11-16, 2024* *Bangkok, Thailand*
AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI) Undergraduate Consortium	*February 20-27, 2024* *Vancouver, Canada*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Research Track – **Best Reviewer Nominee**	*October 8-12, 2023* *Salt Lake City, UT*
Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) Student Research Workshop	*July 10-12, 2023* *Toronto, Canada*
Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP) Dialogue and Interactive Systems Track	*December 7-11, 2022* *Abu Dhabi, UAE*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Software Track	*October 24-28, 2022* *Pomona, CA*
ACM Conference on Creativity & Cognition (C&C) Posters Track	*June 20-23, 2022* *Venice, Italy*
AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI)	*February 22-March 1, 2022* *Virtual*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Research Track	*October 11-15, 2021* *Virtual*
IEEE Conference on Games (CoG) Narrative and Interactive Entertainment Short Papers	*August 17-20, 2021* *Copenhagen, Denmark/Virtual*
Interactive Narrative Technologies (INT) Workshop at AIIDE	*October 19-20, 2020* *Virtual*
Procedural Content Generation (PCG) Workshop at Foundations of Digital Games (FDG)	*September 14, 2020* *Bugibba, Malta*
International Conference for Interactive Digital Storytelling (ICIDS) Human Factors	*November 19-23, 2019* *Little Cottonwood Canyon, UT*
Procedural Content Generation (PCG) Workshop at Foundations of Digital Games (FDG)	*August 26, 2019* *San Luis Obispo, CA*
Workshop on Storytelling at ACL	*August 1, 2019* *Florence, Italy*
Workshop on Narrative Understanding at NAACL	*June 7, 2019* *Minneapolis, MN*
Knowledge Extraction from Games (KEG) Workshop at AAAI	*January 27, 2019* *Honolulu, HI*
AAAI Conf. on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment (AIIDE) Artifact Evaluation	*November 13-17, 2018* *Alberta, Canada*
Workshop on Storytelling at NAACL-HLT	*June 5, 2018* *New Orleans, LA*

Invited Talks and Panels

Summary

6	**Special Conference Presentations**
15	**On-Campus Invited Speaker Presentations**
4	**Panels**
25	**Total Presentations**

Special Conference Presentations

"Aging Up AAC: An Introspection on Augmentative and Alternative Communication Applications for Autistic Adults"

CCC Computing Futures Symposium – *Washington, D.C.* ..... *May 15-16, 2025*

CIFellows Symposium – *Washington, D.C.* ..... *May 13-14, 2025*

"Digital Bards: How Dungeons & Dragons will Make for Better AI"

NULab for Texts, Maps, and Networks Spring Conference at Northeastern University – *Boston, MA* ..... *April 21, 2023*

↦ **Keynote Speaker**

"Using Storytelling to Understand the Technological and Experiential Requirements of Interactive Improvisational Agents"

Tapia Doctoral Consortium – *San Diego, CA* ..... *September 18, 2019*

↦ **Winner of Best Doctoral Consortium Presentation Award**

"Secrets of Computer Science Revealed"

STARS Alliance Celebration – *Atlanta, GA* ..... *August 17, 2013*

"CS Outreach Amongst Piscataway Youth"

STARS Alliance Celebration – *Atlanta, GA* ..... *August 16, 2013*

Invited Speaker Presentations

"Leveraging Large Language Models (LLMs) to Create Personalized Augmentative and Alternative Communication Systems (AACs)"

University of Maryland, Baltimore County - COEIT Research Day – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *April 11, 2025*

"Bridging the Social & Technical Divide in Augmentative and Alternative Communication (AAC) Applications for Autistic Adults"

University of Maryland, Baltimore County - CSEE Research Day – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *May 3, 2024*

"Neurosymbolic AI or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Large Language Model"

Human Language Technology Center of Excellence (HLTCOE) – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *April 18, 2024*

University of Maryland, Baltimore County - HCC Group FIKA – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *March 4, 2024*

Johns Hopkins University – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *February 16, 2024*

University of Maryland, Baltimore County – *Baltimore, MD* ..... *February 27, 2023*

Drexel University – *Philadelphia, PA* ..... *February 15, 2023*

"Neurosymbolic Storytelling or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Large Language Model"

University of Maryland, College Park - CLIP Colloquium – *College Park, MD* ..... *October 4, 2023*

"Dungeons and Discourse: Using Computational Storytelling to Look at Natural Language Use"

University of Southern California - NL Seminar – *Los Angeles, CA/Virtual* ..... *May 22, 2022*

University of California, Santa Cruz - Computational Media Seminar – *Santa Cruz, CA/Virtual* ..... *November 29, 2021*

Georgia Institute of Technology - NLP Seminar – *Atlanta, GA/Virtual* ..... *September 11, 2020*
Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory – *Livermore, CA/Virtual* ..... *June 11, 2020*

"Dungeons and Discourse: Using Computational Storytelling & Speech to Look at Natural Language Use"

University of Pennsylvania - CLUNCH (Computational Linguistics Lunch) Seminar – *Philadelphia, PA/Virtual* *January 25, 2021*
University of Utah – *Salt Lake City, UT/Virtual* ..... *April 20, 2020*

"Using Storytelling to Understand the Technological and Experiential Requirements of Interactive Improvisational Agents"

Georgia Tech - GVU Brown Bag – *Atlanta, GA* ..... *January 23, 2020*

Panelist

STEM Research & Publication Faculty Panel *October 13, 2025*
University of Maryland, Baltimore County - AOK Library and Grad Student & Postdoctoral Development *Baltimore, MD*

Doctoral Consortium Advice Panel *October 9, 2023*
AIIDE Conference - Doctoral Consortium *Salt Lake City, UT*

Computer Science PhD Panel *February 11, 2023*
University of Pennsylvania - FemmeHacks *Philadelphia, PA*

Future of Language Research *February 20, 2020*
Georgia Institute of Technology - IPaT Thursday Think Tank *Atlanta, GA*

Advising Summary

4 **PhD Thesis Advisees**
5 **MS Thesis Advisees**
8 **Other PhD Advisees**
27 **Other MS Advisees**
11 **Undergrad Advisees**
55 **Total Advisees**

PhD Advising

University of Maryland, Baltimore County

Ray Groshan *Fall 2025 – Present*
PhD Computer Science

Marcus McAllister *Spring 2025 – Present*
PhD Computer Science
Co-Advised with Dr. Cynthia Matuszek

Arya Honraopatil *Summer 2024 – Present*
PhD Computer Science

Patty Delafuente *Spring 2024 – Present*
PhD Computer Science

Masters Thesis Advising

University of Maryland, Baltimore County

Naren Sivakumar — *Spring 2024 – Spring 2025*
MS Computer Science → PhD at UMBC
Thesis: Emulating Rational Decisions with Traditional and Contemporary AI

Shadab Choudhury — *Spring 2024 – Spring 2025*
MS Computer Science
Thesis: Connecting Language and Emotion in Large Language Models for Human-AI Collaboration

University of Pennsylvania

River Yijang Dong — *Summer 2022 – Spring 2023*
BA Mathematics/MS Data Science → PhD at Oxford University
Thesis: COTTAGE: Coherent Text Adventure Games Generation

Anna Orosz — *Spring 2021 – Fall 2021*
MS Data Science → Machine Learning Engineer at LinkedIn
Thesis: Generating Text-based Adventure Games

Sri Sanjeevini Devi Ganni — *Fall 2020 – Spring 2021*
MS Data Science → SDE at Amazon
Thesis: Narratology and Fanfiction

Other Mentorship

University of Maryland, Baltimore County

Krish Mehta — *Spring 2026 – Present*
MS Computer Science

Maria Antonette Vanya — *Spring 2026 – Present*
MS Computer Science

Paul Abili — *Summer 2025 – Present*
BS Computer Science

Venkata Sai Harsha Kothapalli — *Fall 2025*
MS Computer Science

Lahari Vuppalapati — *Fall 2025*
MS Computer Science

AJ Boyd — *Fall 2024 – Spring 2025*
BS Computer Science → Data Engineer at Visa

Asha Kumar — *Summer 2024 – Fall 2024*
PhD Human-Centered Computing

Dedeepya Palakurthi — *Fall 2024*
MPS Data Science → Software Engineer at CVS Health

Saksham Kumar Sharma — *Fall 2024*
MS Computer Science

Ashish Athimamula — *Fall 2024*
MS Computer Science

June Young
MS Computer Science
Spring 2024 – Fall 2024

Shawn Bray
PhD Computer Engineering
Spring 2024 – Fall 2024

Arya Honraopatil
MS Computer Science → PhD Student at UMBC
Spring 2024

Tori Saylor
BS Computer Science
Spring 2024

Runsheng "Anson" Huang
MS Data Science at UPenn → AI Engineer at Terrasoft
Spring 2023 – Spring 2024

Christopher Cui
MS Computer Science at Georgia Tech → PhD Student at UC San Diego
Summer 2023 – Fall 2023

Outreach

Mark McGovern
Out in Tech U's Mentorship Program
Summer 2022

University of Pennsylvania

Malathy Nagalakshmi
MS Computer and Information Science → SDE at Amazon
Summer 2022 – Summer 2023

Andrew Zhu
PhD Computer and Information Science
Fall 2022 – Spring 2023

Tianyi Zhang
MS Data Science
Fall 2022

Karmanya Aggarwal
MS Data Science → ML Scientist at Nabla Bio, Inc.
Fall 2022

Alexander Feng
MS Data Science → Research Data Scientist at Booz Allen Hamilton
Summer 2022 – Fall 2022

Manni Arora
MS Computer and Information Science → Software Engineer at Siri NL
Summer 2022

Pooja Dattatri
MS Computer and Information Science → Application Developer at the University of Pennsylvania
Summer 2022

Shifan "Tim" Dong
BS at Washington University in St. Louis → Software Developer at DRW
Summer 2022

Salvatore Giorgi
PhD Computer and Information Science
Summer 2022

Ke "Coco" Zhao
BA Cognitive Science & Computer Science → SDE at Amazon
Summer 2022

Bryan Li
PhD Computer and Information Science
Spring 2021 – Spring 2022

Georgia Institute of Technology

Siyan "Sylvia" Li — *Spring 2020 – Fall 2020*
BS Computer Science → MS student at Stanford University

Sruthi Sudhakar — *Spring 2020*
BS Computer Science → PhD student at Columbia University

Kimberly Caras — *Spring 2020*
MS Computer Science → D&A Modeler at KPMG Digital Lighthouse

Winston Li — *Fall 2019 – Fall 2020*
BS Computer Science → Quantitative Research Engineer at Citadel

Andrew Silva — *Fall 2019*
PhD Computer Science

Srijan Sood — *Summer 2018 – Summer 2019*
MS Computer Science → Research Engineer at JP Morgan

Jainesh Doshi — *Spring 2019*
MS Computer Science → Machine Learning Engineer at JP Morgan

Taha Merghani — *Summer 2018 – Fall 2018*
MS Computer Science → AI & Deep Learning Engineer at Decooda

Ethan Tien — *Spring 2018*
BS Computer Science → CS MS student at Georgia Tech

Prithviraj Ammanabrolu — *Spring 2017 – Spring 2018*
BS Computer Science → CS PhD student at Georgia Tech

Pradyumna Tambwekar — *Spring 2017 – Spring 2018*
MS Computer Science → CS PhD student at Georgia Tech

Richa Arora — *Spring 2017 – Spring 2018*
MS Computer Science → Google Analytics

Xinyu "Lily" Wang — *Spring 2017 – Spring 2018*
MS Computer Science → MS Language Technologies student at Carnegie Mellon

Nathan Dass — *Spring 2017 – Fall 2017*
BS Computer Science → MS student at Stanford University

Murtaza Dhuliawala — *Spring 2017*
MS Computer Science → Research Software Engineer at IBM Research

Koustuv Saha — *Fall 2016*
PhD Computer Science

Yuval Pinter — *Fall 2016*
PhD Computer Science

Shruti Singh — *Spring 2016 – Fall 2016*
MS Computer Science → Software Development Engineer at Amazon

Will Hancock — *Spring 2016 – Fall 2016*
MS Computer Science → PhD student at Northwestern University

Thesis Committee Member

PhD — *Defense Date / Advisor*

Tung Duong Ta ..... *TBD*
PhD Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Tim Oates*

Michael Majurski ..... *TBD*
PhD Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Cynthia Matuszek*

Sai Vallurupalli ..... *TBD*
PhD Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Frank Ferraro*

Amal Alabdulkarim ..... *Expected 2026*
PhD Computer Science at Georgia Institute of Technology — *Dr. Mark Riedl*

Shahin Hossain ..... *Expected 2026*
PhD Language, Literacy, and Culture at UMBC — *Dr. Ramon Goings*

Masters — *Defense Date / Advisor*

An May ..... *Expected 2026*
MS Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Cynthia Matuszek*

Kaoru Seki ..... *November 5, 2025*
MS Human-Centered Computing at UMBC — *Dr. Yasmine Kotturi*

Santiago Góngora ..... *August 11, 2025*
MS Computer Science at Universidad de la República, Uruguay — *Dr. Luis Chiruzzo*

Ekele Ogbadu ..... *April 26, 2024*
MS Computer Science at UMBC — *Dr. Cynthia Matuszek*

Career Development

Fall 2025 – Present — **Faculty Learning Committee on *Designing Humanizing Assignments in the Age of AI***

January 2026 — **University of Washington Book Club for *Disabling Intelligences: Legacies of Eugenics and How We are Wrong about AI***

Summer 2024 — **NCFDD Faculty Success Program**

Conference Attendance

September 10-12, 2025 — **CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Celebration of Diversity in Computing**

May 15-16, 2025 — **CCC Computing Futures Symposium**

May 13-14, 2025 — **CIFellows 2025 Symposium**

February 20-23, 2024 — **CRA Career Mentoring Workshops (CMW)**

September 18-21, 2019 — **ACM Richard Tapia Celebration of Diversity in Computing**

April 15-16, 2016 — **CRA-Women Graduate Cohort Workshop**

October 2-5, 2013 — **Anita Borg Institute's Grace Hopper Celebration**

August 16-17, 2013 — **CRA STARS Alliance Celebration**

Media Coverage

Jul 11, 2025 — **"Interactive Storytelling with AI – Dr. Lara Martin"**
Jacob & Warren Tingen — *Tingenuity AI (podcast)*

Aug 19, 2023	**"Hallucinating ChatGPT finds a role playing Dungeons & Dragons"** Thomas Claburn	*The Register*
Fall 2022	**"Next-Gen Innovators: Penn Engineering Postdoctoral Fellows Lead the Way on Groundbreaking Research"** Amy Biemiller	*Penn Engineering Magazine*
Autumn 2021	**"Lara Martin: "How can I get a system to tell a story about anything I want?""** Masoud Golsorkhi	*TANK Magazine, Issue 88 (Narrative)*
Mar 15, 2021	**"Lara Martin on teaching AI to tell stories"** Amy Barrett	*BBC Science Focus Podcast*
Feb 17, 2021	**"Alexa, tell me a story"** Amy Barrett	*BBC Science Focus Magazine*
Apr 16, 2020	**"Meet ML@GT: Lara J. Martin Trains AI Agents to Become Storytellers"** Allie McFadden	*Georgia Tech Machine Learning, Memos from MLGT*
Feb 28, 2020	**"Forget Chess—the Real Challenge Is Teaching AI to Play D&D"** Will Knight	*Wired*
Feb 4, 2020	**"Changing the Conversation: Georgia Tech Researchers Provide New Approach to Automated Story Generation"** David Mitchell	*Georgia Tech School of Interactive Computing*
Feb 6, 2019	**"Pictionary-Playing AI Sketches the Future of Human-Machine Collaborations" (mention)** Eliza Strickland	*IEEE Spectrum*
Feb 2, 2018	**"Georgia Tech Artificial Intelligence Research Includes Collaborative Approaches with Humans, Automating Content, and More"** Joshua Preston	*Georgia Tech GVU Center*